

NAVAL MESSAGING ULTIMATE STUDY CHEAT SHEET

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Mission of Naval Communications

The primary mission is to provide and maintain **secure and rapid communications**, based on **wartime requirements**, to meet the needs of Naval Operating Forces. These communications are categorized as:

- **Internal:** Communications within the ship (e.g., phones).
- **External:** Ship-to-ship or off-ship communications.

Core References and Procedures

- **NTP-1 (Navy Telecommunications Procedures):** Known as the "Bible for Comms," specifically Chapters 3, 5, and 7.
- **NTP-4 (Navy Telecommunications Procedures):** Referenced for manual procedures.
- **ACP 131F (Allied Communications Publication):** Contains communications instructions and operating signals (Q and Z signals).
- **PQS (Personnel Qualification Standards):** Associated with communications/network maintenance, deck watches, and damage control.

Major Organizations and Commands

Command/Agency	Full Name and Mission
DISA	Defense Information Systems Agency: Provides operational direction of the DCS (Defense Communications System) . Ensures system improvements for long-haul, point-to-point requirements.
DCS	Defense Communications System: Supports the three military departments (Navy, Army, Air Force) and other DoD (Department of Defense) activities.
USFF	United States Fleet Forces Command: Trains, certifies, and provides combat-ready Navy forces capable of prompt, sustained, joint, and combined operations.
NAVIFOR	Naval Information Forces: Provides forward-deployable, fully trained, manned, and capably equipped information warfare forces.

NETWARCOM	Naval Network Warfare Command: Executes tactical-level command and control to direct, operate, maintain, and secure Naval Communications.
NCDOC	Navy Cyber Defense Operations Command: Enables global power projection through protective network defense (reporting/defense against viruses and phishing).
NCMS	Navy Communications Security Material System: Maintains the COR (Office of Record) for DON (Department of the Navy) CMS (Communications Security Material System) and KMI (Key Management Infrastructure) .
NIOC	Navy Information Operations Command: Supports IO (Information Operations) and SIGINT (Signals Intelligence) operations; consists of 15 NIOCs and 16 subordinate detachments.

Regional Master Stations and Infrastructure

- **NCTAMS (Naval Computer and Telecommunications Area Master Station):** Operates and maintains information transfer systems providing real-time **C4I (Command, Control, Communications, Computers, and Intelligence)** support.
 - **NCTAMS LANT (Naval Computer and Telecommunications Area Master Station Atlantic):** Located in Norfolk, Virginia.
 - **NCTAMS PAC (Naval Computer and Telecommunications Area Master Station Pacific):** Located in Wahiawa, Hawaii.
- **NCTS (Naval Computer and Telecommunications Station):** Provides IT infrastructure and support within an **AOR (Area of Responsibility)**. There are 7 locations reporting to **NCTAMS (Naval Computer and Telecommunications Area Master Station)**:
 - Jacksonville, FL
 - San Diego, CA
 - Bahrain
 - Guam
 - Naples, Italy
 - Yokosuka, Japan (Far East)
 - Sicily
- **JFTOC (Joint Fleet Telecommunications Operations Center):** The primary control point for day-to-day operations at each **NCTAMS (Naval Computer and Telecommunications Area Master Station)**. Manning includes a 24/7 Watch Officer.
- **FLTNOCs (Fleet Network Operations Centers):** Provides critical **IP (Internet Protocol)** services.
 - **UARNOC (United Atlantic Region Network Operations Center):** NCTAMS LANT.
 - **PRNOC (Pacific Region Network Operations Center):** NCTAMS PAC.
 - **ERNOC (European Central Region Network Operations Center):** NCTS Naples.
 - **IORNOC (Indian Ocean Region Network Operations Center):** NCTS Bahrain.

Networks and Information Enclaves

Network	Full Name and Classification
NIPRNET	Non-classified Internet Protocol Router Network: Unclassified but sensitive; used for day-to-day IP data communications.
SIPRNET	Secret Internet Protocol Router Network: DoD's largest interoperable command and control data network (SECRET). Supports GCCS (Global Command and Control System) .
JWICS	Joint Worldwide Intelligence Communications System: The SCI (Sensitive Compartmented Information) portion of the DISN (Defense Information Systems Network) (TOP SECRET). Supports point-to-point exchange of voice, text, and video.

The Watchstanding Chain

Position	Responsibility
CO (Commanding Officer)	Overall responsible for the communications and mission of the command.
COMMO (Communications Officer)	Responsible for organization, supervision, and coordination of exterior communications.
RO (Radio Officer)	Responsible for the COMMSPLAN (Communications Plan) , SOP (Standard Operating Procedure) , and the Watch, Quarter, and Station Bill . (Note: On small ships, COMMO (Communications Officer) and RO (Radio Officer) may be the same person).
CWO (Communications Watch Officer)	Highest qualified enlisted (usually E4-E6); ensures all messages (incoming/outgoing) are handled accurately and rapidly in accordance with regulations.
Tech Control Supervisor (Technical Control Supervisor)	Reports to the CWO (Communications Watch Officer) . Establishes/maintains circuits, initiates restoration for failed equipment, and maintains the status board.
CMS (Communications Security Material System) Custodian	Manages the CMS (Communications Security Material System) account; advises the CO (Commanding Officer) on physical security and handling of COMSEC (Communications Security) material.

Security, Inventory, and Logs

- **TPI (Two Person Integrity):** A security measure to prevent a single person from having access to **Top Secret** material and higher.
- **Inventory Procedures:** Conducted during every watch section change.
 - Must be performed by the oncoming watch supervisor and a witness.
 - Includes a visual inventory of all **COMSEC (Communications Security)** equipment.
 - Requires a page-check of all **COMSEC (Communications Security)** publications.
- **MSL (Master Station Log):** The official narrative record. **No erasures allowed.** Must include:
 - New Radio Day
 - Watch Turnover
 - Messages Received
 - Circuit Status/Outages
 - Inventories and Significant Events (e.g., Power failures, **HAZCONs (Hazard Conditions)**).
- **Central Message Log:** Specifically used for logging all messages after they have been recorded in the appropriate circuit log.
- **SOP (Standard Operating Procedure):** Step-by-step instructions for routine and emergent situations (e.g., HF Voice, **COMMSHIFT (Communications Guard Shift)** procedures).

Message Precedence and Word Limits

Minimize Conditions: Used to reduce non-essential traffic to allow for critical messages.

- **Flash** traffic is restricted to a maximum of **100 words**.
- **Immediate** traffic is restricted to a maximum of **200 words**.

Precedence	Prosign	Time Requirement
Flash	Z	ASAP / 10 Minutes
Immediate	O	30 Minutes (0.5 hours)
Priority	P	3 hours
Routine	R	6 hours
Yankee	Y	ASAP

Naval Message Types and Roles

Message Roles

1. **Originator:** The authority (Command/Activity) in whose name the message is sent.
2. **Drafter:** The person who composes the message; responsible for addressing, format, and classification.

3. **Releaser:** The designated individual authorized to validate and release the message for transmission.

Major Message Types

- **GENSER (General Service):** General official messages ranging from **Unclassified** to **Top Secret**.
- **DSSCS (Defense Special Security Communications System):** World-wide system used to process record message traffic containing **Sensitive Information** or **SCI (Sensitive Compartmented Information)**.
- **CRITIC (Critical Intelligence Message):** Highest priority; used to report critical information about an event or situation directly to senior government decision-makers (e.g., The President).
- **COMMSPOOT (Communications Spot Report):** Used to advise of any situation causing significant disruption of tactical communications.
- **COMMSHIFT (Communications Guard Shift):** Required when a command shifts its guard from one broadcast servicing communications center to another.

Special Handling Markings and Colors

Marking	Full Name / Description
RD	Restricted Data: Data concerning nuclear weaponry or nuclear energy production.
FRD	Formerly Restricted Data: No longer RD, but still must be safeguarded as classified information.
FOUO	For Official Use Only: Official information not requiring classification that must be protected from public release.
EFTO	Encrypted For Transmission Only: Unclassified messages that could reveal sensitive info if combined piece by piece.
SPECAT	Special Category: Classified messages for special projects (e.g., Limited Distribution, Personal For, NATO Restricted).

Classification Memory Colors:

- **Unclassified (U):** Green
- **Confidential (C):** Blue
- **Secret (S):** Red
- **Top Secret (T):** Orange

Addressing and NAVMACS

- **NAVMACS (Naval Modular Automated Communications System):** Shipboard message processing system used for secure and expedient communications.
- **PLA (Plain Language Address):** A single station's address written in an easily understood format.

- **AIG (Address Indicator Group):** A collection of **16 or more** frequently occurring **PLAs (Plain Language Addresses)**.
- **CAD (Collective Address Designator):** A collection of **4 or more PLAs (Plain Language Addresses)** sharing a common operational or administrative chain of command.

Message Format Lines

Line	Element	Description
1	Transmission Identification	Identification info for the transmission.
2	Message Header	Contains precedence, classification, and routing indicators.
4	Security Warning	ZNR = Unclassified; ZNY = Confidential or higher.
5	DTG (Date Time Group)	Format: DDHHMMZ MMM YY (e.g., 262022Z JUN 25).
6	Originator	"FROM" field (Command sending the message).
7	Action Addressee	"TO" field (Who must act on the message).
8	Information Addressee	"INFO" field (For awareness, similar to CC).
11	Break	The "BT" prosign separating the header from the body.
12	Text (Body)	Actual message content. Starts with SSIC (Standard Subject Identification Code) .
13	Break	The "BT" prosign after the message body.
14	Validation	Contains the SSN (Station Serial Number) .
16	Ending Sign	8 carriage returns followed by NNNN .

Format Line 2: Character Positions

- **Position 4:** Classification (U, C, S, T)
- **Position 5-8:** **CIC (Content Indicator Code)** (Tells what kind of message it is)
- **Position 10-15:** **OSRI (Originating Station Routing Indicator)**
- **Position 17-20:** **SSN (Station Serial Number)** (Number of messages per month)
- **Position 22-24:** Julian Date
- **Position 25-28:** Time Filed (Zulu time)
- **Position 34:** Routing Indicator (Where the message is going)

Format Line 12: Body Components

- **SUBJ:** Subject
- **REF:** Reference
- **AMPN:** Amplification (Used when there is only one reference)
- **NARR:** Narrative (Required when multiple references are used)
- **RMKS:** Remarks (Used to explain the purpose of the message)

Operating Signals (ACP 131F)

Signal	Meaning
ZUG	No
ZUE	Yes
ZUJ	Stand by
ZUJ 1	Wait one
QSL	I acknowledge receipt
INT QSL	Have you received / Please acknowledge
ZBZ	Question concerning printing acceptability of signals
INT QBZ	Interrogative procedural signal